

proximity to these lights may feel an uncomfortable warmth coming from inside of them or restless energy, but nothing debilitating. Fiends and undead, however, feel a searing pain when close to these lights, taking 1d6 radiant damage per turn and must make a DC 15 Wisdom save or be frightened for 1 minute.

AREA A1 – THE GREAT DOORS

A pair of towering silvery doors act as the main entrance into the manse, leading to the main hall (area A2). Their shining silvery surfaces act as two great mirrors that show the reflection of anyone approaching.

As the adventurers approach the doors they hear a booming voice that asks them the following riddle:

Always running

Never walking

Sometimes babbles

But never talking

What am I?

(The answer is a river.)

Alternatively, replace this riddle with any other that you'd like, or a different puzzle entirely. Or, if you're not fond of riddles/puzzles at all, the doors can ask for a password, or state of intent, before allowing entry.

If the adventurers do not answer to the door's satisfaction, they do not open. Any attempt to force the doors open causes the doors -- which are actually 2 **mimics** (MM p220) -- to attack.

The two silvery doors suddenly fly out of the door frame towards you. Their flat surfaces quickly stretch and warp into giant gaping maws with long, powerful tongues curling back as if readying itself to swat at you.

In combat, the mimics attack with their pseudopod "tongue." Once the target is grappled, the mimic reels in the target for a vicious bite (attacks with advantage due to its Grappler trait). The mimics have been tasked with guarding the entrance and fight to the death, but do not chase fleeing adventurers outside of the grove clearing.

AWARDING EXPERIENCE POINTS

Divide 900 XP equally among the characters if the party answers the riddle or defeats the mimics.

AREA A2 – MAIN HALL

The main hall can be accessed by passing through the great doors (A1), the west parlor (A3), the dining hall (A4), or smashing through the stained glass windows (see "Climbing the Walls").

The ruinous remains of fine marble pillars line the hallway here; some toppled over, others reaching up to the vaulted ceiling but coming short of the top. Hollow suits of armor are on display along the wall, standing vigil with their hollow gauntlets wrapped around ceremonial blades.

Bursting through the center of the hall is a cylindrical stone tower. Only a portion of the tower is contained in this hallway: its wall extends beyond the main hall, and it ascends beyond the ceiling.

High above, rain courses in dark rivulets down the stained glass windows above the main doorway. In the crash of lightning, the stained glass casts the chamber in flashes of red and violet.

Paired doors stand to your left and right. Across the hall, a shiny brass door offers a way inside the tower.

The door to the left leads to the west parlor (A3), the door to the right leads to the dining hall (A5), and finally up ahead leads into the tower's staircase (A9).

Each step causes the old eroding wooden floor to creak ominously. Six suits of armor on display have engravings of moon motifs and of soaring herons. They are rusted and are littered with dust and cobwebs. Three of the suits of armor on display are in fact haunted guardians: **animated armors** (MM p19) ([PICTURE](#)) holding **flying swords** (MM p20); they are indistinguishable from mundane items unless a character can detect magic. Siegfried cast *prestidigitation* to make them look old and unused.

A character investigating the brass doorway into the tower notices a small nearly invisible message on the door. A DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check recognizes this as a *glyph of warding* spell, but not what type. The font is tiny and requires getting close to read it. The message says, "read this out loud."

SHOULDN'T HAVE DONE THAT

If a character says the message out loud, it triggers the *explosive runes*, releasing a 20-foot radius explosion of electricity from the glyph. Each creature caught in the explosion must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 3d8 lightning damage on a failed saving throw or half as much damage on a successful one.

If the explosive runes are triggered or dispelled, the 3 **animated armors** holding 3 **flying swords** immediately come to life and attack the party, fighting until destroyed.

DEVELOPMENTS

Unless the party is deliberately being quiet, the vampire Lambert hears them. He uses his scroll of *disguise self* to look like a human cathar and begins shouting for help from inside the west parlor (A3).

AWARDING EXPERIENCE POINTS

Divide 800 XP equally among the characters if the party defeats the animated armors and flying swords.

AREA A3 – WEST PARLOR

The west parlor is connected to the main hall (A2).

Decades of neglect has deteriorated what was once a cheerful parlor. Baby-blue walls hold the slashed and torn remnants of old family portraits. Elegant chairs with poofy cushions surround a small wooden circular table, engravings of majestic stags run laps along its edges. A bookcase cover the western wall.

Lambert Spinne, a **vampire warrior** (APPENDIX B), resides in this small room.

ILLUSIONS AND TRICKERY

If the PCs made a commotion either by fighting the mimics at the entrance (A1) or make noise inside the main hall (A2), Lambert uses one of his scrolls of *disguise self* to take the appearance of a human cathar before calling out for help. If this happens and the adventurers open the door, and if they have a light source, read or paraphrase:

Standing inside the room is a man that appears to be in his mid 30's.

He is decked head to toe in the studded leathers of a combat-ready cathar, a mix of white and brown, topped with a leather tri-corner hat.

"Thank Avacyn, someone has come! Please, help! The madman owner of this house has kept me prisoner here, says he plans to experiment on me. Please, before his foul minions arrive!"

Lambert speaks the truth: Siegfried is indeed keeping him prisoner for future experiments. He's certainly withholding information, however. If questioned, the vampire disguised as a cathar keeps repeating that he'll explain everything once he's free, that they must hurry before patrols come.

TRAPPED

The vampire explains what is keeping him here: it is not a physical barrier, but a magical one. He points to a straight

unbroken line of silver powder on the ground under the doorway. He hurries them in an anxious voice to wipe away the line of powder so that he can escape.

The powdered silver radiates an aura of magic (abjuration). Inquisitive characters can make a DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) or (Religion) check to recognize the line of powdered silver as a magic circle against evil. The magic circle binds Lambert; he cannot cross the line's boundary until the line is broken, nor can he disturb the line himself.

Anyone other than the vampire can dispel the magic circle by simply breaking the line of powdered silver, for example sweeping it away with their foot.



ART BY JAMES RYMAN

LAMBERT'S TRUE SELF

If they catch Lambert unaware, see through his illusion, or the vampire spawn drops his *disguise self* spell, they instead see a gaunt, pale-skinned man in fine aristocratic clothing that looks straight out of a Victorian noble's wardrobe: a vest of red and gold, high black leather boots, a black high-collared cape that is red on the inside. Lambert's striking eyes; golden irises in a pool of black sclera, are a telltale sign of vampirism, glinting in the darkness like a cat's. (PICTURE)

Like most vampires, Lambert has a smug sense of superiority over mortals, which he compares

his own kind as "shepherds watching over our sheep." He acts with restraint towards the characters, which he respects to some degree for making it this far. He watches them with curiosity and amusement.

INTERVIEW WITH THE VAMPIRE

If the adventurers don't fall for his ruse, Lambert changes tactics. Instead of relying on the characters' good will, he entices them with money, power, and information. He explains that he is from a very rich and influential family, the Voldaren vampires. Lambert guarantees that the characters will be handsomely rewarded if they free him.

If the characters are willing to negotiate his release for information, wealth, or power, Lambert has one request: step into his parlor. A character (one or more) has to sit down at the table with him during the talks as a sign of good faith. He gives his word that he will not harm anyone

that enters the room so long as they do not attack him.

WHAT LAMBERT KNOWS

Lambert is willing to barter information for his release. He has only been a vampire for two years now and does not know any secrets that would be left for Voldaren elders, but he can readily answer any general questions about Stensia and Innistrad that an average citizen would know.

In addition, he has juicy bits of information that the characters may be interested in:

- He participated in Katarina's abduction (see "Voldaren's Lesson" in the Introduction) and her subsequent "crowning" as a mock "Queen of the Vampires," but was not permitted to feast on her at the celebrations' end, "unfortunately there's only so much blood to go around."
- The vampire families were disturbed when they found out about the zombie horde laying waste to the countryside. They followed the corpse wagons (and destroyed the zombies pulling them) back to Mauer Estate
- Lambert was sent to spy on Siegfried, but the Estate is incredibly well protected against vampires: he specifically mentions the strange aura of radiant energy surrounding the tower which "seared my flesh as I approached"
- The vampire was eventually caught by Siegfried and is now kept here for future experiments

DEVELOPMENTS

If Lambert tricks the adventurers into breaking the magic circle against evil with his disguise, keeps up his act long enough for him to break from the party and escape. He isn't looking for a fight, instead hoping to return home as quickly as possible.

If the adventurers see through his ruse and agree to negotiate for his release by entering his room, Lambert keeps his word of not harming them. He can promise them riches for his release, within reason -- treat his promised riches as a Treasure Horde CR 5 (DMG p137) to see what he can and cannot give. If they agree on a price and free the vampire, a week later a package arrives to the characters with the promised items.

Or he can promise a favor from his brethren: what that favor ends up being is up to you. For example, he could put in a good word towards the vampire elders, should any character wish to become "gifted" with vampirism. Other favors could be free passage alongside Voldaren's territories, or a promise not to feast on people living in a specific village for a full year.

If the characters refuse to release him, the vampire shouts insults at them as they leave, warning them that

when he is freed he and his brethren will hunt the party down and devour them for their insolence. He may show up in the future with a few vampires to attack the party.

If pressed into combat, Lambert's only hope is to fight them inside his room, as the vampire has no ranged capabilities. But he can get out of line of sight easily, hiding in corners of the room so that anyone looking to attack him would have to enter to get a clear shot.

SECRET ROOM

The bookcase is filled with books ranging from a variety of topics, including history, biology, geography, etc. A DC 13 Intelligence (Investigation) both reveals a sliding mechanism around the bookcase and that one book, "*Camouflage and Its Practical Applications*," stands out amongst the rest. Pulling on the book swings the bookcase open, revealing a hidden room (A4).

AWARDING EXPERIENCE POINTS

Divide 1,800 XP equally among the characters if the speaks with and/or destroys Lambert.

TREASURE

The vampire was stripped of most notable possessions, but he managed to keep two scrolls of *disguise self* hidden inside his boots.

Most of the dusty tomes on the bookcase are valuable (10-30gp each), but two are particularly noteworthy:

The Sacred Waters of Sumnerryl, describes the location of an ancient sinkhole hidden away in province Kessig whose waters are rumored to contain mystical powers. It would be worth 150gp to the druids of Kessig, plus could be a hook for a future adventure.

Fall From Glory is actually a hollowed out book holding a golden hourglass. The "sand" of the hourglass is powdered ruby. The hourglass is worth 400gp to the right (extremely wealthy) buyer.

AREA A4 – HIDDEN ROOM

This room is accessed via a secret doorway in the parlor (A3). None of Mauer Estate's current inhabitants know about this room, making it the perfect spot for adventurers to rest. A lever on a wall inside the room opens and closes the secret entrance.

A font bubbles in the middle this small room, its silver liquid sparkling with fair dawn's light. Encircling its broad base is a mosaic depicting a silver heron and a dark fiendish goat in eternal chase. An inscription is written on the font's rim.

FONT OF BENNU

This blessed font is said to grant knowledge through visions to those who partake without avarice. The inscription on the font's rim reads in Celestial, "A blessing for the righteous; a curse for avarice." Anyone who drinks from the font experiences a vision of the past and potentially the future. The imbiber gains a bit of magical potential, whose benefit that character can activate at a time of their choosing. Once activated, the benefit is expended.

A character who drinks from the fountain more than once is afflicted with the disfavor of Bennu. The character does not receive the font's benefit, instead gaining a level of exhaustion.

When a character drinks from the font for the first time, roll 1d4 and consult the following list. You can also improvise or create specific visions, perhaps revealing additional story information that hints at future adventures beyond this one.

1. Vision of Sacrifice: The character witnesses a massive black rupture in the sky, fiends and other horrors emerging from it. A glowing heron flies into the portal and erupts into a mist of silver. There is a blinding flash of light which then dims to reveal the silver moon of Innistrad.

Benefit: As a reaction, the character can claim this benefit when an ally they can see within 30 feet of them takes damage, taking that damage instead and negating half of it.

2. Vision of Past Valor: The characters witness a scene of Avacyn fighting with an equally powerful demon (Griselbrand), the Helvault standing in the background.

Benefit: As a free action, the character can claim this benefit to take an additional bonus action.

3. Vision of Inspiration: This vision shows the Church of Avacyn at the height of its power, humans and angels working together to drive the horrors away from their lands.

Benefit: As a free action, the character can claim this benefit to gain an inspiration point.

4. Vision of Future Glory: This vision shows a huge silver mass (the Helvault) standing at the center of a garden. The object explodes with a flash of radiance and an army of devils stream out.

Benefit: As a free action, the character can claim this benefit to gain an additional Dash action.

AREA A5 – DINING HALL

A vaulted hall stretches before you, anchored by a great stone fireplace on one end and a wall decked in old ceremonial swords on the other. Between them are three long tables capable of seating an entire company. Rotting body parts are heaped on the tables in great hideous piles: arms, legs, heads, and other parts. Old wooden bowls,

drinking horns, and knives are strewn about the floor mixed in with debris.

The stone tower at the center of the manse cuts a swath into this hall, jutting out of a corner. A dumbwaiter has been built into the tower, its metal cart suspended by thick ropes.

The dining hall can be accessed by the main hall (A2), the kitchen (A6), or through the fireplace (see "Climbing the Walls").

The corpses littering the tables have been brought here from the corpse wagons sitting in the stables (A6). Shilgengar, the **demonlord of ashmouth** (Appendix B) and his five **crawling claw** helpers (MM p44) work here day and night. They chop up the corpses into body parts and sort them into piles (head, arms, legs, torso, hands, feet) on the tables.

The shaft on the tower wall is a dumbwaiter: it leads from the dining hall to the top of the tower (A10) where Siegfried works. Periodically, a quasit from the top of the tower (A10) calls down the shaft of the dumbwaiter for a specific body part. Shilgengar and his helpers fill the cart with the body part, then the demon turns a crank that lifts the cart up to the tower with ropes on pulleys.

Shilgengar has been commanded by a powerful archdemon to aid Siegfried with his projects and push him further towards utter madness. While the taskmaster has been overseeing supplying Siegfried with body parts, his accomplice, the quasit Qarr (A10), whispers fiendish suggestions in the stitcher's ear.

Shilgengar relishes the chance to inflict pain on any invaders. If taken below 20 hit points, the demon tries to retreat, ideally by flying up the dumbwaiter shaft and warning Siegfried (A10). If killed, the demonlord's essence dissolves and reforms inside the pits of ashmouth months or years later, ready to enact his vengeance on the adventurers.

GOING UP THE DUMBWAITER

A crank operates the dumbwaiter, raising or lowering the metal crate inside the shaft. Turning the crank requires a Strength check: the DC is 5 for an empty crate, up to 15 when it's at maximum capacity. An adventurer can operate the crank while the rest of the party is in the crate to send them up the shaft.

Alternatively, adventurers can climb up the shaft. Climbing the thick ropes attached to the crate requires at DC 10 Strength check. They can also climb the walls, but the smooth surface makes it difficult to find grips, requiring a DC 15 Strength check. Failure by 5 or more means the character loses grip and falls.

The dumbwaiter goes up 50 feet to the top of the tower, the alchemist's lab (A10).

AWARDING EXPERIENCE POINTS

Divide 1,850 XP equally among the characters if the party destroys the *barlgura* and the five crawling claws.

TREASURE

If defeated, adventurers can pick up the *butcher's cleaver* (APPENDIX A) left on one of the tables.

The corpses thrown into this room weren't thoroughly searched. A diligent investigation of the corpses finds two platinum rings (75gp each); a pouch containing 15 cp, 13 ep, and a *potion of vitality*; and a disembodied hand clutching a *wand of magic missiles*.

AREA A6 – KITCHEN

Adventurers can enter the kitchen either through the dining hall (A5) or through Eudora's secret tunnel, (see "Lady of the Woods") which leads to a hidden doorway behind a cabinet in the kitchen.

Four **charmbreaker devils** (APPENDIX B) ([PICTURE](#)) in this kitchen are currently having a crisis: Shilgengar, the demonic taskmaster in the adjacent dining hall (A5) has demanded that they cook him a meal. The fiend has not been pleased with the devils' disastrous attempts at cooking and threatens to annihilate them if they do not satisfy him with their next dish.

Unless the adventurers were exceptionally loud in an adjacent room, for example casting *thunderwave*, the fiends here are so preoccupied smashing things that they don't hear even the sounds of battle.

As the adventurers approach the kitchen, they hear:

You hear a commotion coming from beyond the door: ceramics shattering, metal plates clanging on the stone floor, and anxious guttural shrieks and barks of multiple creatures.

Characters that understand the Abyssal language can make out what the shrieks and barks are saying: "We need more of the green sauce!" "What about more shoe?" "I don't know!" "This is hopeless! Shilgengar is gonna kill us!" "We don't even have taste buds, for Grazz't's sake!"

If they look inside the kitchen:

You see four humanoid creatures leaping around a kitchen.



Their sinewy red bodies are armored by wicked chitinous spikes that adorn their body, from the back-swept horns on their head to their long prehensile tails. They frantically rummage through dusty cabinets and shelves, carelessly knocking pots and plates over as though searching for something in particular.

IRON CHEF

When the charmbreaker devils spot the adventurers, they quickly try to bargain with them before the adventurers attack:

"Wait!" One of the devils speaks to you in broken Common, "you help us, we help you! Yes? You cook, yes?"

If the adventurers are willing to listen, the devils explain their situation trying to cook for Shilgengar. If the characters help them cook a good meal, the devils will spike the meal with a ***potion of sleep***, which will put the taskmaster into a deep sleep. This arrangement would benefit both parties: the PCs can walk past Shilgengar undisturbed, while the charmbreaker devils get a much-needed break from cooking.

The kitchen has a wide array of ingredients that range from reasonable to awful: ripe apples, a human hand, a worn-out shoe, cinnamon, vials of newt spittle, a rabbit, a hag's eye, ground pepper, a barrel filled with red wine, and anything else you want to add. The devils have a stew heating over a wood-burning stove that has the shoe floating in water.

Should they take the devils' offer, the adventurers must cook a meal out of the ingredients. The devils have no